FUTURES MATTER EDUCATION

Futures Matter - Northwood, 122 Emily Street, Highgate, Birmingham, B12 0XJ

Curriculum Policy

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1.0 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy sets out what we teach at Futures Matter - Northwood, how and when we teach it, and how we make sure it is safe, inclusive and effective. It applies to every pupil and every member of staff, and to learning on site, offsite and online. It is the written curriculum policy required by the Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014 and it is supported by curriculum maps, schemes of work and lesson plans.

Our Curriculum Statement (FME-CU-08) is a shorter, public summary of our curriculum written for pupils, families and professionals. This policy gives the detail that staff and leaders work to.

2.0 ETHOS, VALUES AND AIMS

Our motto is Futures Matter. We believe that everyone has a personal best and that we play a vital part in making that a reality. Our pupils are successful adults in the making, and we set no ceiling on what they can achieve.

Everything we do is guided by four values: we are **Ambitious**, **Respectful**, **Resilient** and **Kind**.

Our curriculum is pupil-centred, ambitious, relevant and engaging. It aims to:

- deliver a broad, balanced and ambitious curriculum, based on the National Curriculum and adapted to each pupil's needs, strengths and interests
- build each pupil's sense of safety, trust and readiness to learn alongside academic challenge
- give every pupil the knowledge, skills and qualifications they need for their next stage of education, training or employment, and for adult life
- teach pupils how to keep themselves and others safe, in the community and online
- support pupils' spiritual, moral, social and cultural development and prepare them for life in modern Britain
- promote a positive attitude to learning, resilience and independence
- ensure staff are supported through training, coaching and professional development to deliver excellent teaching

British values are a strong theme of our curriculum: democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty, and mutual respect and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs are taught explicitly and lived every day, in every subject, in tutor time, in assemblies and in the way we treat one another. We think of the curriculum as a carefully sequenced journey, not a checklist of subjects. It is composed of every moment of every school day, from breakfast on arrival to reflection at the end of the afternoon.

3.0 LEGISLATION AND GUIDANCE

As an independent school we do not have to follow the National Curriculum, but we follow it as far as possible, adapted to our pupils' needs. This policy meets the requirements of the Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014 and is based on:

- Part 1 of the Standards (quality of education), which requires a written curriculum policy, supported by plans and schemes of work, that gives pupils experience in linguistic, mathematical, scientific, technological, human and social, physical, and aesthetic and creative education, and includes personal, social, health and economic

education, relationships and sex education, careers guidance and preparation for adult life
- Part 2 of the Standards, on pupils' spiritual, moral, social and cultural development, including the promotion of fundamental British values
- the Equality Act 2010, including the duty to make reasonable adjustments for disabled pupils
- the Children and Families Act 2014 and the Special Educational Needs and Disability (SEND) Code of Practice: 0 to 25 years
- the statutory guidance on Relationships Education, Relationships and Sex Education (RSE) and Health Education, and on careers guidance and access for education and training providers
- Keeping children safe in education (the current edition), including the requirement to teach pupils about safeguarding, including online safety, and to have appropriate filtering and monitoring in place
- the Prevent duty, under the Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015
- the DfE filtering and monitoring standards and its guidance on teaching online safety and on the safe use of generative artificial intelligence in education
- sections 406 and 407 of the Education Act 1996, on political impartiality
- the Ofsted inspection framework for non-association independent schools

We have no early years provision, so the Early Years Foundation Stage framework does not apply.

4.0 OUR PUPILS

Futures Matter - Northwood is a DfE registered independent special school (URN 152552), part of Futures Matter Education Ltd, for up to 20 pupils aged 11 to 16. Our pupils have a range of needs, most often social, emotional and mental health (SEMH) needs and autism (ASC). Many also have speech, language and communication needs (SLCN), ADHD, moderate learning difficulties or experience of trauma. Many have had few positive experiences of school, may be working below age-related expectations, and have experienced disruption in their education or home lives. Most have an Education, Health and Care Plan (EHCP) and some are in care.

Classes are capped at five pupils, with a Teacher or Instructor and a Teaching Assistant in every class. Pupils attend for 190 days over 38 weeks, aligned as far as possible with Birmingham City Council term dates, and receive 32.5 hours of education each week. As a newly opened school, we currently teach in very small groups or one to one, planned around each pupil's EHCP, and we introduce the full range of subjects and vocational options as pupil numbers grow.

Our facilities include teaching rooms, a nurture and sensory regulation space, a calm space for emotional regulation, a teaching kitchen, a social dining and breakout space, outdoor space, and dedicated workshop space for a growing work-related curriculum. As our cohort grows we aim to introduce Motor Vehicle Maintenance, Hairdressing and Barbering, and Painting and Decorating.

5.0 HOW OUR DAY AND WEEK ARE STRUCTURED

Structure is part of our curriculum. Pupils with SEMH and ASC needs learn best when the day is predictable, transitions are few and every adult is clear about what happens next. We therefore use one whole-school timetable for every tutor group, from 8.45am to 3.15pm,

Monday to Friday, and we plan it to reduce transitions, build in social communication and interaction, and make room for sensory, therapeutic and clinical support.

5.1 The school day

Time	What happens	Why
8.45 to 9.00	Arrival and Breakfast Club	A calm, social start and a healthy breakfast
9.00 to 9.15	Tutor groups and registration	Welcome, check-in and preparation for the day
9.15 to 10.00	Period 1: Maths	Protected daily maths
10.00 to 10.45	Period 2: English	Protected daily English
10.45 to 11.00	Break	Rest, play and social time
11.00 to 11.45	Period 3: Science (Mon), Humanities (Tue, Wed, Fri), Computing and Digital (Thu)	Science, humanities and digital learning
11.45 to 12.15	Structured Reading	30 protected minutes every day
12.15 to 12.45	Lunch	A social meal
12.45 to 12.55	10-minute check-in: reflection and co-regulation	Settling for the afternoon
12.55 to 1.55	Period 4: PE offsite in Small Heath (Mon), Science (Tue), D&T Food theory (Wed), Careers Education (Thu), Offsite Enrichment (Fri)	Practical and applied learning
1.55 to 2.55	Period 5: PE offsite in Small Heath (Mon), PSHCE (Tue), D&T Food practical (Wed), Science (Thu), Offsite Enrichment (Fri)	Practical and applied learning
2.55 to 3.15	Reflection and tutor time	Ending the day well
3.15	School ends	Pupils are escorted to transport home

The timetable for every tutor group is displayed in each classroom as a visual schedule. Each pupil's personal timetable may vary from it where their EHCP, needs or strengths require, for example with fewer transitions, a base room, or therapeutic input. Any change to a pupil's timetable is agreed by the Head Teacher and recorded in their support plan.

5.2 Why the day is shaped this way

- **Maths and English come first.** They are taught every day in Periods 1 and 2, when pupils are most alert, so that regular practice builds fluency and confidence.
- **Registration and breakfast come before learning.** Pupils who arrive hungry, anxious or dysregulated are welcomed, fed and settled first. The Arrival and Breakfast Club and tutor time are part of the curriculum, teaching routine, social skills and healthy choices.
- **Reading is protected.** Structured Reading takes place every day for 30 minutes, whatever else is happening.
- **Regulation is planned.** The 10-minute check-in after lunch and reflection and tutor time at the end of the day give every pupil a moment to reset, be heard and be reconnected with an adult.
- **The afternoon is practical.** Periods 4 and 5 are 60-minute blocks, so that practical, applied and offsite learning has the time it needs. D&T Food is a double lesson: theory first, then practical.

- **Pupils are escorted home.** Pupils are escorted to their transport at 3.15pm, which keeps the end of the day calm and safe.

5.3 The week

Subject	When	Time each week
Maths	Period 1, every day	3 hours 45 minutes
English	Period 2, every day	3 hours 45 minutes
Structured Reading	After Period 3, every day	2 hours 30 minutes
Science	Monday P3, Tuesday P4, Thursday P5	2 hours 45 minutes
Humanities (History, Geography, R.S.)	Period 3 on Tuesday, Wednesday and Friday	2 hours 15 minutes
Computing and Digital	Period 3 on Thursday	45 minutes
D&T Food (theory, then practical)	Wednesday, Periods 4 and 5	2 hours
PE (offsite)	Monday, Periods 4 and 5 (Small Heath)	2 hours
PSHCE	Tuesday, Period 5	1 hour
Careers Education	Thursday, Period 4	1 hour
Offsite Enrichment (community and life skills)	Friday, Periods 4 and 5	2 hours
Total taught time		**23 hours 45 minutes**

PE takes place offsite in Small Heath on Monday afternoons (Periods 4 and 5), planned and risk assessed under our Educational Visits Policy.

The remaining time in the 32.5-hour week is arrival and breakfast, registration, break, lunch, the daily check-in and reflection and tutor time. We count these as part of the curriculum. Time for therapeutic or clinical input, interventions and catch-up is built into individual pupils' timetables as needed, and the Head Teacher, Proprietor and Chair of the School Governance Board review the balance of curriculum time each year.

Art, music and drama are offered through a rolling programme of Musician and Artist in residence, so that every pupil has experience of aesthetic and creative education.

6.0 LOW THREAT, HIGH CHALLENGE

Pupils with SEMH and ASC needs can only access an ambitious curriculum once they feel safe, regulated and understood. Building trust, co-regulation and emotional wellbeing, informed by Thrive principles, therefore sits alongside academic progress at every stage. Ambition and emotional safety are not in tension: they depend on each other. A member of staff starts the Thrive Wellbeing Specialist Teaching Assistant apprenticeship (Level 5) in November 2026, to be fully trained as our Thrive Lead. They will then help staff to assess pupils' social and emotional development and plan targeted support.

6.1 Low threat

Staff create a low-threat environment by:

- keeping routines predictable and using visual timetables, clear expectations and calm, consistent language

- building warm, trusting relationships, so that every pupil is known well and feels they belong
- noticing early signs of anxiety or dysregulation, and offering regulation first (a conversation, a movement break, the calm space or the nurture and sensory regulation space) before asking pupils to learn
- using the daily check-in to co-regulate, and reflection and tutor time to end the day well
- never using humiliation, sarcasm or public shaming, and treating mistakes as a normal part of learning
- repairing relationships after incidents so that pupils can start again, in line with our Behaviour, Rewards and Sanctions Policy
- using only the de-escalation and, as a last resort, physical intervention techniques in which staff are trained (GCM, Global Conflict Management), in line with our Restrictive Interventions Policy

6.2 High challenge

Staff set high challenge by:

- teaching the full breadth of the National Curriculum content wherever possible, and adapting how it is taught, not what pupils are expected to aspire to
- using high-quality schemes of work (White Rose Maths, White Rose Science and Pearson English) tailored to each pupil's needs and starting point
- planning a sequence of learning that builds on what pupils already know, and revisiting it regularly through retrieval practice and over-learning
- teaching vocabulary explicitly, and checking understanding by skilful questioning
- agreeing personal targets with each pupil, linked to their EHCP, so that pupils know what they are working towards and what comes next
- expecting effort, perseverance and kindness from every pupil, and recognising and celebrating them
- offering recognised qualifications from Year 7

6.3 Low barrier

We remove barriers to learning by:

- careful differentiation and scaffolding
- pre-teaching of key vocabulary for pupils with SLCN
- visual supports and task management boards for pupils with working memory difficulties
- structured routines and clear learning objectives for pupils with ASC
- access arrangements for assessments and examinations
- contracting in Speech and Language Therapy and other clinical input where a pupil's EHCP requires it

7.0 SAFEGUARDING EMBEDDED IN THE CURRICULUM

Safeguarding is at the heart of all we do, and the curriculum is one of our most important safeguarding tools. Pupils who understand risk, know their rights, can recognise unsafe situations and know whom to tell are safer. Safeguarding is therefore planned into the curriculum, not added to it.

7.1 What pupils learn and where

Where it is taught	Safeguarding learning
PSHCE and RSHE (Tuesday, and woven through the week)	Healthy and unhealthy relationships, consent, respect, bullying, peer pressure, sexual harassment and abuse, exploitation (including criminal and sexual exploitation and county lines), knife crime, substance misuse, mental health and wellbeing, keeping safe in the community, and how and where to seek help
Computing and Digital, PSHCE and tutor time	Safer use of technology: content, contact, conduct and commerce, privacy and security, AI, wellbeing and online extremism (see section 8.0)
Humanities, English and Structured Reading	Respect, tolerance, democracy, the rule of law and individual liberty, resisting extremist and hateful narratives, critical thinking about sources and media, and the emotional safety of the texts chosen
D&T Food and Science	Food safety and hygiene, safe use of equipment and chemicals, first aid and taking care of our bodies
PE and Offsite Enrichment	Risk, personal safety, road and water safety, travelling safely and independently, and staying safe in the community
Careers Education and Work-Related Learning	Staying safe and knowing their rights at work, exploitation at work, safe use of social media and online profiles, and safe recruitment into jobs and courses
Tutor time, check-ins and assemblies	Knowing a trusted adult, how to share a worry, the school's safeguarding message, themes of the week and current issues

7.2 How we teach it safely

- Content is age-appropriate, matched to each pupil's developmental stage and needs, and planned in line with our Relationships, Sex and Health Education Policy.
- Staff plan sensitive lessons carefully, using what they know about each pupil's history, and the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) is consulted where a topic may be particularly difficult for a pupil, including for pupils who have experienced abuse, neglect or loss.
- Pupils are warned in advance about sensitive topics, may step out or take a break at any time, and are supported afterwards. Staff do not ask pupils to share personal experiences.
- Staff remind pupils that they cannot promise confidentiality when someone may be at risk, and that they will always listen.
- If a pupil says or does anything in a lesson that raises a concern, staff follow our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and tell the DSL on the same day, or immediately where a pupil is at risk.
- Pupils know who our DSL and deputy DSLs are and how to ask for help, in person or through the other routes we provide.
- External visitors and speakers are vetted, supervised and briefed, and their materials are checked in advance in line with our Preventing Extremism and Radicalisation Policy and our duty of political impartiality.
- Every offsite activity is risk assessed under our Risk Assessments Policy and Educational Visits Policy.

8.0 SAFER USE OF TECHNOLOGY

Technology is part of our pupils' futures, and it is also where many of the risks they now face begin. Our approach has two parts: teaching pupils to use technology well and to stay safe, and protecting them through the systems and rules we use in school. We use innovative new teaching platforms and technology to bring learning alive and to prepare our young people to be responsible digital citizens, able to use technology creatively, critically and kindly. Staff choose platforms and tools carefully, check them before they are used with pupils and keep them under review. Every year we mark Safer Internet Day in February with a programme of learning for the whole school, and we draw on its themes throughout the year.

8.1 What pupils learn

Safer use of technology is taught explicitly in Computing and Digital, PSHCE and tutor time, and reinforced in every subject where technology is used. Pupils learn about:

- **Content:** how to judge whether information is true, biased or designed to persuade, and how to deal with upsetting, harmful or age-inappropriate content, including pornography, violence, self-harm material and hateful or extremist content
- **Contact:** online grooming, exploitation and coercion, how people can hide who they are, and how to block, report and tell a trusted adult
- **Conduct:** respectful behaviour online and responsible digital citizenship, including respect for the law and for other people's views, online bullying, sharing images, the law on nude and semi-nude images, and the lasting effect of their digital footprint
- **Commerce:** scams, phishing, gambling-style game mechanics, in-app purchases, advertising and the sale of personal data
- **Privacy and security:** strong passwords, account security, privacy settings, and protecting personal information
- **Artificial intelligence:** how generative AI works, where it is useful and where it is wrong, biased or unsafe, fake and AI-generated images, voices and videos (deepfakes), never entering personal information into AI tools, and the rules on using AI in assessed work
- **Wellbeing:** the effect of screen time, social media and gaming on mood, sleep and relationships, and healthy habits
- **Online hate and extremism:** how online spaces can be used to radicalise, and how to challenge extremist views
- **Digital skills for life:** the skills pupils need to learn, work and live independently, including communicating, searching, creating and using online services safely

8.2 How we keep pupils safe

- **Filtering and monitoring.** School devices and networks are filtered and monitored in line with the DfE standards and our Filtering and Monitoring Policy. The DSL is responsible for the filtering and monitoring arrangements, and checks are carried out and recorded regularly.
- **Supervised use.** Pupils use school devices and the internet for learning, under adult supervision. Staff plan the use of any website, app or online tool in advance and check it before it is used with pupils.
- **Mobile phones.** Pupils' mobile phones must be agreed with the Head Teacher and are handed in on entry, in line with our Mobile Phone Policy.
- **Artificial intelligence.** Pupils use AI tools only where staff have approved them for a specific learning purpose, with an adult present. Staff do not enter pupils' personal

data into AI tools, and use only tools that have been assessed for safety and data protection. Our AI Policy (FME-CU-11) sets out the rules for pupils and staff and the process for approving tools.

- **Personal data and cyber security.** Pupil information is protected under our Data Protection Policy and Cyber Security Policy and Response Plan.
- **Online safety concerns.** Any online safety concern, including from lessons and from monitoring alerts, is recorded and passed to the DSL, and acted on under our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and Online Safety and Acceptable Use Policy. Concerns about online bullying are handled under our Anti-Bullying Policy.
- **Partnership with families.** We share advice with parents and carers on the apps, games and platforms their children use, and on parental controls.
- **Staff.** Staff receive regular safeguarding and online safety training, including on filtering and monitoring and the safe use of AI, and follow our Staff Code of Conduct when using technology and communicating with pupils.

9.0 SUBJECT PROVISION

The Standards require us to give pupils experience in each of the areas of learning below. This table shows how our curriculum provides them.

Area of learning	How we provide it
Linguistic	English, Structured Reading and reading across the curriculum, and speaking and listening
Mathematical	Mathematics and numeracy, including Functional Skills and GCSE pathways
Scientific	Science, including biology, chemistry and physics
Technological	Computing and Digital, including AI literacy and safer use of technology, and Design and Technology (Food)
Human and social	History, geography and religious studies, PSHCE and RSHE, citizenship and careers education
Physical	Physical Education, including offsite sports and outdoor activities
Aesthetic and creative	Art, music and drama, through a rolling programme of Musician and Artist in residence

9.1 English and Maths

English and Maths are taught every day. English follows Pearson English, with a focus on reading, writing, vocabulary, speaking and listening. Maths follows the White Rose Maths scheme of work, sequenced to build fluency, reasoning and problem-solving, with Numicon: Breaking Barriers for pupils working significantly below their age, and BKSB (Basic Key Skills Builder) to identify gaps and track Functional Skills and GCSE pathways.

9.2 Science

Science follows White Rose Science and is taught for three lessons each week, covering biology, chemistry and physics, with practical work in our science facilities.

9.3 Humanities

Humanities is timetabled around a theme. Depending on the theme and on pupils' needs, history, geography and religious studies are taught as discrete subjects or together in a cross-curricular way, and they are linked through our Themes of the Week. Discrete teaching

gives pupils clarity about what they are learning and allows explicit teaching of subject knowledge and vocabulary, while cross-curricular teaching helps pupils make connections and keeps learning relevant. Humanities is also where pupils explore British values, democracy, the law and different faiths and cultures in depth. Religious studies draws on Birmingham's Locally Agreed Syllabus.

9.4 Computing and Digital

Computing and Digital covers digital literacy, computer science, information technology and AI literacy, together with the safer use of technology set out in section 8.0. We use innovative new teaching platforms and technology to bring learning alive and to prepare our young people to be responsible digital citizens, and we mark Safer Internet Day every February. Pupils work towards qualifications such as Functional Skills ICT and Entry Level Certificates in ICT.

9.5 Design and Technology (Food)

D&T Food is a double lesson. The first lesson teaches knowledge, skills and understanding, including food safety, hygiene, nutrition and planning, and the second gives hands-on cooking experience so that pupils apply their learning immediately. Pupils build confidence and independence in essential life skills and work towards qualifications such as Food Hygiene.

9.6 Physical Education

PE is delivered offsite in Small Heath on Monday afternoons, in high-quality lessons covering a wide range of sports and activities on rotation, such as football, yoga, fitness, sailing and climbing. It builds health, resilience, teamwork and self-regulation. Offsite PE is planned and risk assessed in line with our Educational Visits Policy.

9.7 PSHCE and RSHE

PSHCE (personal, social, health, citizenship and economic education) is both a timetabled subject and a golden thread through the whole curriculum. We use the PSHE Association programme to ensure systematic coverage of relationships, health and wellbeing, and living in the wider world, and we teach Relationships, Sex and Health Education (RSHE) in line with our Relationships, Sex and Health Education Policy. Parents and carers can find out what is taught and how to ask to withdraw their child from sex education in that policy.

9.8 Careers Education and Work-Related Learning

All pupils have access to independent, impartial careers guidance, following the Gatsby Benchmarks. Key Stage 3 pupils take part in a week of employer encounters across Years 7 to 9. Key Stage 4 pupils have taster days, work-related learning and work experience with vetted local employers, and Year 11 pupils use the services agreed with Birmingham's Careers Service. See our Careers and Work-Related Learning Policy and Work Experience Policy and Procedures.

9.9 Offsite Enrichment and the wider curriculum

Offsite Enrichment, every Friday afternoon, takes learning into the community and builds life skills, citizenship and cultural capital through visits, community projects and life skills activities, and through activities such as the Duke of Edinburgh's Award, which we are introducing. We are in consultation to register as a new Duke of Edinburgh's Award provider and are recruiting an instructor, and we will confirm a start date once both are in place. The

Award will build independence, resilience and teamwork through volunteering, physical activity, skills development and an expedition. Pupils also take part in the Student Board, assemblies, celebrations and standalone days. Assemblies, Themes of the Week and celebrations mark national and community events such as Remembrance Day, Black History Month and Safer Internet Day, and bring British values to life.

9.10 Structured Reading

Every pupil reads for a protected 30 minutes every day at 11.45am. Staff match pupils to books they can read and want to read, read aloud and model fluent reading, and use assessment to give extra support to pupils who need it. We aim for every pupil to leave school with a reading age beyond a functional level. Reading Champions help to celebrate reading by recommending books and mentoring peers. Pupils who cannot yet decode are taught phonics using Read Write Inc. Fresh Start. Reading is covered in full in our separate Reading Policy (FME-CU-09).

9.11 Homework and Independent Learning

Homework is child led. Many of our pupils have had negative experiences of homework, or find it hard to work independently outside school, so pupils choose whether, when and how to take learning home, with support from staff and families. Reading is the priority, and every pupil is encouraged to read at home, with book recommendations and support for families to make this enjoyable. Pupils may choose to practise something they have learned, finish a piece of work or research a topic that interests them, and staff help them to plan it. Homework is never used to teach new content, is not required, and no pupil is penalised for not doing it. We build independence in lessons, Structured Reading and Offsite Enrichment, so that pupils develop the skills they will need in further education, training and employment, and we explain our approach to parents and carers so that learning at home supports their child rather than causing stress.

10.0 SPIRITUAL, MORAL, SOCIAL AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT AND BRITISH VALUES

Spiritual, moral, social and cultural (SMSC) development, citizenship, British values and the protected characteristics are golden threads through tutor time, assemblies, PSHCE, humanities and enrichment. We teach pupils to respect the fundamental British values of democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty, and mutual respect and tolerance of those with different faiths, beliefs and cultures. We teach about the protected characteristics in the Equality Act 2010 (age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex and sexual orientation), and staff challenge derogatory views about them. We teach British values explicitly and live them every day. Pupils learn about democracy through the Student Board, class votes and elections, and in humanities and PSHCE; the rule of law through our behaviour expectations, citizenship and PSHCE, including the role of the police and the courts; individual liberty through choices, rights and responsibilities, including online; and mutual respect and tolerance through religious studies, assemblies, celebrations, Themes of the Week and enrichment in the diverse communities of Birmingham. Assemblies and Themes of the Week mark national and community events such as Remembrance Day, Black History Month and Safer Internet Day, and pupils' understanding of British values is tracked using SMSC Gridmaker.

Pupils have a voice through the Student Board. As our school grows, pupils will experience a democratic selection process for representatives from each class or Key Stage.

11.0 INCLUSION

All our pupils have special educational needs, and most have an EHCP, so inclusion is the starting point of our curriculum, not an addition to it. We respond to each pupil's needs and remove barriers to learning for pupils with SEMH needs, autism, SLCN, ADHD and moderate learning difficulties, pupils who have been out of school for a long time, pupils in care, pupils with English as an additional language (EAL), pupils with particularly high attainment and pupils with low prior attainment.

Teachers:

- set high expectations for every pupil and use assessment to set ambitious targets and plan challenging work
- plan lessons so that pupils with SEN and disabilities can study every subject, wherever possible, with no barriers to achievement
- use scaffolding, pre-teaching of vocabulary, visual supports and structured routines, and plan with each pupil's EHCP outcomes and, for pupils in care, their Personal Education Plan
- plan lessons so that pupils whose first language is not English develop their English and can take part in every subject
- make reasonable adjustments for disabled pupils under the Equality Act 2010, including access arrangements for assessments and examinations
- check that teaching materials do not discriminate against anyone

New pupils are assessed and observed during their first 12 weeks, so that staff can understand their needs, identify strategies and make sure there are no unidentified needs. If additional needs are identified during this period, or at any point afterwards, we discuss our concerns with parents and carers (and with the pupil where appropriate), adapt the curriculum and teaching to meet the pupil's needs, and put in place targeted support such as additional phonics teaching, speech and language therapy (contracted in where the EHCP requires it) or social and emotional support. We refer to external specialists where needed, with parental consent, and review the pupil's EHCP outcomes and support plan, requesting an early annual review if the pupil's needs have changed significantly. Every adaptation and intervention is recorded in the pupil's support plan and reviewed regularly to check that it is working. Induction and transition plans are bespoke, and we support pupils to move at a good pace towards full-time education on site. Further information is in our SEND Policy, Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy, English as an Additional Language Policy and Accessibility Plan.

12.0 ACCREDITATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

Accreditation starts in Year 7 with the AQA Unit Award Scheme and Entry Level qualifications, and by Year 9 pupils can sit Level 1 Functional Skills. At Key Stage 4, each pupil follows a personalised pathway that may include Functional Skills, Entry Level Certificates, GCSEs and equivalents, and vocational and life skills qualifications such as Basic First Aid, Food Hygiene and the Duke of Edinburgh's Award. Every pupil is supported to achieve GCSEs and/or nationally recognised qualifications. Appendix 1 lists the qualifications we offer or aim to offer.

For a short time after opening, pupils sit examinations at other local schools or colleges, and the school will apply to become an examinations centre, so that in time pupils can sit their examinations on site in a familiar, supportive environment. Because only a small number of pupils sit public examinations each year, results are not published on our website, so that no individual can be identified. Results are reported to parents and carers by personal letter on results day, and every parent and carer receives an annual report on progress and attainment.

13.0 ASSESSMENT AND IMPACT

Assessment tells us what pupils know and can do, informs the next step in planning and shows whether our curriculum is working.

- **Records and reporting.** Pupil records, attendance, behaviour, progress data and reports are held on Arbor, which is currently being configured for assessment and reporting.
- **Academic progress** is assessed formatively in lessons against the success criteria for each subject, and summatively each term, with SOLAR used to track key concepts and skills.
- **EHCP outcomes and small steps** are tracked using GL Assessments between formal annual reviews.
- **Social and emotional progress** is monitored through Boxall profiling, staff observation, and data on attendance, attitude, engagement, rewards and sanctions.
- **Reading** is assessed on entry and regularly afterwards, so that reading support is targeted.
- **SMSC, British values and protected characteristics** are tracked using SMSC Gridmaker.
- **Safeguarding learning** is checked through pupil voice, PSHCE assessment and tutor conversations, so that we know pupils understand how to stay safe, including online.
- **Progress is reviewed** with pupils, parents and carers, the local authority and other professionals at an early annual review within 12 weeks of admission, at each annual review, and at transition reviews at key points, where the pupil's views are heard and recorded.

Our curriculum is working when pupils:

- are interested in learning, positively engaged and achieving
- remember what they learn, build on it and make progress in every subject
- are prepared for each new stage of learning and gain nationally recognised qualifications, including in English and Maths
- meet the outcomes in their EHCP (and Personal Education Plan)
- have a career pathway identified in line with their strengths and interests
- become less reliant on adult support over time
- know how to keep themselves safe, fit, healthy and secure, online and offline
- feel accepted and valued, with growing self-esteem and confidence, and have positive ways of coping
- show respect, kindness and pride, and are prepared to contribute positively as citizens

Our Assessment, Feedback, Marking, Recording and Reporting Policy (FME-CU-10) gives the detail of how we assess, mark, record and report.

14.0 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

The Proprietor and the Chair of the School Governance Board approve and monitor this policy and hold the Head Teacher to account for it. They make sure that the school teaches a broad and balanced curriculum that meets the Independent School Standards, with enough teaching time to cover it; that proper provision is made for pupils with different abilities and needs, including pupils with SEN and an EHCP; that pupils receive independent, impartial careers guidance that is properly resourced; and that the school has appropriate filtering and monitoring in place and teaches pupils about online safety.

The Head Teacher is responsible for:

- devising curriculum maps, long-term plans and schemes of work with teaching staff
- making sure every subject has aims and objectives that reflect the aims of the school and show how the needs of individual pupils will be met
- making sure the time given to each part of the curriculum is adequate, and reviewing it with the Proprietor and Chair of the School Governance Board
- making sure safeguarding, including safer use of technology, is planned into the curriculum
- managing requests to withdraw pupils from curriculum subjects, including sex education, in line with the RSHE Policy
- making sure assessment procedures meet all legal requirements and that the curriculum is inclusive and accessible to all
- reporting to the Proprietor and Chair of the School Governance Board each year on the progress and standards pupils achieve and on how all pupils access the curriculum
- making sure teaching materials do not discriminate against anyone, and that political issues are presented in an objective and balanced way

The Designated Safeguarding Lead advises on safeguarding content in the curriculum, oversees filtering and monitoring, and is told about any concern arising in lessons.

Subject Leads lead the provision and delivery of their subject, plan and review schemes of work, support colleagues, monitor progress and how their subject is taught, manage resources, and make sure the subject is inclusive and accessible.

Teachers and Instructors implement this policy consistently, plan lessons that reflect the school's curriculum, adapt teaching to each pupil's needs, use technology safely, celebrate pupils' achievements, assess and record progress, and report concerns about progress, wellbeing or safety.

Teaching Assistants support pupils to access learning, help them to regulate, and give feedback to the teacher, following the plan for each pupil.

15.0 MONITORING AND REVIEW

We monitor the curriculum through planning and work scrutiny, learning walks on specific themes, peer and formal lesson observations, and discussion with pupils about their learning. Staff are supported through appraisal, pair teaching, coaching and personalised professional development. The Head Teacher and subject leads identify strengths and priorities in the School Evaluation Form and the School Development Plan, and the Quality of Education is scrutinised by an external School Improvement Partner and by Ofsted. The

Proprietor and the Chair of the School Governance Board monitor the curriculum through the Head Teacher's annual report, school visits and meetings with the Student Board.

The Head Teacher reviews this policy at least once a year, and sooner if the law or guidance changes. At every review the Head Teacher, Proprietor and Chair of the School Governance Board look at what we intend pupils to learn, the effectiveness of our teaching, the impact on pupils, and the safeguarding and technology content in particular. At every review the policy is approved by the Proprietor and shared with the full School Governance Board.

16.0 RELATED POLICIES

- Curriculum Statement (FME-CU-08)
- Careers and Work-Related Learning Policy (FME-CU-02)
- Work Experience Policy and Procedures (FME-CU-03)
- Relationships, Sex and Health Education Policy (FME-CU-04)
- SEND Policy (FME-SE-01)
- Accessibility Plan (FME-SE-03)
- English as an Additional Language Policy (FME-SE-04)
- Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy (FME-SE-05)
- Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy (FME-SG-01)
- Online Safety and Acceptable Use Policy (FME-SG-02)
- Filtering and Monitoring Policy (FME-SG-03)
- Preventing Extremism and Radicalisation Policy (FME-SG-04)
- Staff Code of Conduct (FME-SG-07)
- Behaviour, Rewards and Sanctions Policy (FME-BE-01)
- Anti-Bullying Policy (FME-BE-02)
- Restrictive Interventions Policy (FME-BE-03)
- Mobile Phone Policy (FME-BE-05)
- Risk Assessments Policy (FME-HS-04) and Educational Visits Policy (FME-HS-05)
- Data Protection Policy (FME-GD-02) and Cyber Security Policy and Response Plan (FME-GD-04)
- Assessment, Feedback, Marking, Recording and Reporting Policy (FME-CU-10), AI Policy (FME-CU-11) and Reading Policy (FME-CU-09)

17.0 APPENDIX 1: ACCREDITATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

The range of qualifications will grow as the school grows. Aspirational subjects are shown as such.

Curriculum area	Qualification	Level
English	Pearson Functional Skills; Pearson Entry Level Certificate in English; Key Skills Communication; GCSE English	Entry 1 to Level 1; Entry 1 to 2; Level 1 and 2
Maths	Pearson Functional Skills; Pearson Entry Level Certificate in Mathematics; GCSE Mathematics	Entry 1 to Level 1; Entry 1 to 3
Science	Entry Level Award in Science; GCSE Science	Entry 1 to 3
Computing and ICT	Pearson Functional Skills in ICT; Pearson Entry Level Certificate in ICT	Entry 1 to Level 2; Entry 1 to 3
Design and Technology, Food	AQA GCSE Design and Technology; Food Hygiene; City and Guilds Award or Diploma in Introduction to	Level 1 and 2; Entry to Level 1

Curriculum area	Qualification	Level
	Hospitality; AQA GCSE Food Preparation and Nutrition	
Motor Vehicle Maintenance (aspirational)	ABC and C&G Motor Vehicle Award	Entry Level 3 and Level 1
Construction Skills and Painting and Decorating (aspirational)	C&G Award in Construction Skills; Principles of Building and Construction; Diploma and Certificate in Painting and Decorating	Entry 3; Level 1 and 2
Hairdressing and Barbering (aspirational)	Awarding body and qualification to be confirmed (for example VTCT or City and Guilds)	To be confirmed
Vocational and work-related skills	The King's Trust: Personal Development and Employability; Preparation for Working Life; Step Up; Working with Others; Improving Own Learning; Problem Solving; Foundation Certificate in Food Hygiene; entry level vocational certificates	Entry to Level 2
Personal and social skills	Certificate in Life Skills; Certificate in Citizenship; Bronze Award and Bronze or Silver Challenge Award; Certificate of Personal Effectiveness (CoPE); St John Ambulance Young Lifesaver Award; Health and Safety; Fire Safety; Highway Code; Bikeability (Birmingham); Bike Maintenance	Entry to Level 2
The wider curriculum	AQA Unit Award Scheme; entry level certificates	Entry 1 and 2

C&G = City and Guilds. Pupils are supported to gain as many externally accredited qualifications as possible.